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Global Macro Commentary | Global

October 2: Quieter Than Usual

Quiet session with US data delayed by shutdown; Challenger report shows slow layoffs and hiring; Indonesia central bank independence concerns; Brazil underperforms amid proposed tax reforms; DXY at 97.846 (+0.1%); US 10y at 4.083 (-1.5bp).

US markets see a quieter-than-usual session with economic data delayed by the ongoing government shutdown, while EM sees more notable moves amid local political developments.

Developed Markets

- **A delay in the weekly US jobless claims data leaves markets with few catalysts, and shutdown negotiations see little progress.** Details of the US administration's proposal to lay off federal workers remain unclear. President Trump meets with OMB Director Vought to [discuss](#) "temporary or permanent" cuts to federal agencies, suggesting a focus on areas not aligned with the administration's priorities. The White House [says](#) the layoff could affect "thousands," but Treasury Secretary Bessent [suggests](#) the proposal is merely a "talking point." On Friday, the US Senate will vote on the funding bill again. Senate Majority Leader Thune [states](#) that if the vote fails, the Senate will likely not reconvene until Monday.
- **US rates pare an initial sell-off after the Challenger report shows fewer job cuts announced in September than expected,** with ~54k planned layoffs representing a 26% y/y decline. However, the overall picture is relatively balanced since hiring plans also fell 71% y/y, suggesting a slowdown in both areas. As a result, the initial bear-flattening is short-lived. Yields retrace lower throughout the afternoon with no clear catalysts, potentially supported by modest dip-buying or unwinding of steeper positions. The Treasury curve ends the day flatter (2y: 0bp; 30y: -2bp).
- **The dollar strengthens slightly (DXY: +0.1%) as risk sentiment remains muted, with the US equities trading sideways (S&P 500: +0.1%).** Tech stocks outperform (Nasdaq 100: +0.4%) amid strong AI-related deal [activity](#). Energy stocks (-1%) and oil-sensitive currencies (USD/NOK: +0.7%; USD/CAD: +0.2%) underperform as oil prices fall further (Brent: -1.7%) in anticipation of OPEC+ supply hikes. Meanwhile, safe-haven currencies store the fewest losses against the dollar (USD/JPY +0.1%, USD/CHF +0.1%).
- **Front-end JGBs open richer in line with the overnight bull-steepening in US rates, but sell off after a weak 10y auction,** which misses expectations with a cut-off price of 100.36 (C: 100.49), though there appears to be solid demand from real money. The sell-off after the auction spills over to the rest of the curve, resulting in a bear-steepening (2y: 0bp; 30y: +2bp).
- **In a quiet session, Euro area rates bull-flatten with support from a slight upside surprise in unemployment (6.3%; C: 6.2%).** Italy [confirms](#) its 3% deficit-to-GDP projection for 2025, setting a target of 2.8% for next year.

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Meanwhile, Switzerland's CPI comes in soft at 0.2% y/y (C: 0.3%).

Emerging Markets

- **AxJ rates mostly rally while currencies hold steady amid local holidays in China and India.** In Indonesia, local rates weaken (10y: +1bp) and IDR strengthens 0.2% against USD following speculative [reports](#) of potential challenges to the central bank's independence from the government. In Korea, local rates and KRW lag regional peers ahead of the six-day local holiday. USD/KRW remains stable despite record \$2.3bn equity inflows from foreign investors, while local rates rally a modest 1bp on higher-than-expected September CPI (2.1% y/y; C: 1.9%).
- **CEEMEA currencies broadly weaken across the region, with South Africa underperforming amid trade uncertainty.** ZAR weakens 0.4% against USD following the expiration of the US African Growth and Opportunity Act (AGOA) trade initiative on Tuesday, with prospects for its extension uncertain amid the US shutdown. The move is supported by softer gold prices (-0.2%). South African rates rally ~3bp across the curve in a risk-off rotation as local equities underperform (FTSE/JSE All: -0.5%).
- **LatAm currencies weaken against the dollar while local rates move in line with the US.** MXN underperforms, weakening 0.3% against USD as the Mexican TIE curve trades ~1bp lower, diverging from US Treasuries. In Argentina, markets see choppy price action as Treasury Secretary Bessent [reiterates](#) US support, but later clarifies that the aid would not entail direct monetary investments in Argentina. ARGENT'35 closes 2 cash points higher, with USD/ARS fairly stable (+0.1%), as Argentine and US officials are expected to continue discussions in the coming days.
- **In Brazil, the curve bear-steepens sharply and BRL weakens 0.2% against USD as the lower house unanimously approves President Lula's income tax reform bill,** which increases taxes on high earners while expanding exemptions for low- and middle-income earners, will now head to the Senate. The measure is [expected](#) to garner support for the administration in a key voter bloc. Local equities also underperform (Ibovespa: -1.1%).

Central Bank Monitor

Developed Markets

- **Dallas Fed President Logan** stated that the Fed needs to be "very cautious" about further rate cuts, highlighting upside risks to inflation and inflation expectations. She noted that demand is still resilient, despite economic crosswinds.
- **Chicago Fed President Goolsbee** stated that the economy "is still growing pretty solidly," highlighting "steadiness in the labor market" despite the lack of official data during the shutdown. Goolsbee highlighted the Chicago Fed's [analysis](#), which suggests the unemployment rate was most likely unchanged in September.
- **ECB Governing Council Member Kazaks** [said](#) the ECB "can keep interest rates where they are unless the economy suffers another shock."

- **ECB Governing Council Member Villeroy** suggested that policymakers aim to strengthen the international role of the euro, including by increasing the issuance of safe assets.
- **BoC Deputy Governor Mendes** said inflation is becoming more volatile due to US trade policy, and the BoC is considering changes to how it measures preferred inflation metrics.

Emerging Markets

- In **Egypt**, the **CBE** lowered its policy rate by 100bp to 21%, in line with expectations.
- In **Korea**, **BoK Deputy Governor Kim** said the September inflation print was in line with earlier projections, and he expects prices to remain around 2% looking ahead. He noted the BoK will keep a close watch on inflation trends given heightened volatility in the FX and oil markets.
- In the **Philippines**, **BSP** said the September inflation print may settle between 1.5-2.3% amid higher prices of rice, fish, and fuel, possibly marking the first time since February that CPI settles within the central bank's 2-4% target range. The central bank also revised its overall balance of payments forecast to -1.4% of GDP for 2025 (P: -1.3%) and -0.6% of GDP for 2026 (P: -0.5%), driven by sustained pressures on the current account (2025e: -3.3% of GDP; P: -3.3% & 2026e: -2.9%; P: -2.5%).

Exhibit 1: G4 Rates Closes (5pm NY)

Tenor	US			Germany			UK			Japan		
	2-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	2-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	2-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	2-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk
2y	3.539	0.4		2.007	(0.3)		3.981	2.0		0.943	(0.9)	
3y	3.552	0.6		2.082	(0.4)		3.979	1.9		0.999	(0.7)	
5y	3.670	(0.2)		2.295	(0.4)		4.136	2.1		1.228	(0.5)	
7y	3.860	(0.8)		2.435	(0.9)		4.293	1.4		1.471	(0.2)	
10y	4.083	(1.5)		2.698	(1.4)		4.709	1.5		1.653	0.7	
20y	4.653	(1.9)		3.179	(1.9)		5.398	0.8		2.619	0.6	
30y	4.688	(2.1)		3.273	(2.5)		5.516	0.7		3.171	1.9	

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 2: Inflation Closes (5pm NY)

Tenor	US TIPS			10y Real Yields, BEI			10y	10y Real Yields, BEI		
	2-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	10y	2-Oct	1d Δ (bp)		2-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk
5y	1.245	2.8		DBRi	0.739	(1.0)		BTPi	1.858	0.4
BEI	2.401	(2.7)		BEI	1.750	(0.0)		BEI	1.709	(1.0)
10y	1.749	0.3		UKTi	1.687	1.3				
BEI	2.331	(1.9)		BEI	3.096	0.0				
30y	2.459	(1.4)		JGBi	0.023	(0.5)				
BEI	2.232	(0.7)		BEI	1.617	1.0				

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 3: Macro Closes (5pm NY)

Majors				EM				Equities / Commodities			
Spot	2-Oct	1d Δ (%)	2wk	Spot	2-Oct	1d Δ (%)	2wk	Index	2-Oct	1d Δ (%)	2wk
DX	97.85	0.1		CNH	7.13	0.1		S&P	6715.35	0.1	
EUR	1.172	(0.1)		INR	--	--		Stoxx	5645.81	1.2	
GBP	1.344	(0.3)		THB	32.37	0.0		FTSE	9427.73	(0.2)	
JPY	147.26	0.1		KRW	1406.35	0.2		Nikkei	44936.73	0.9	
CHF	0.798	0.1		ZAR	17.29	0.3		VIX	16.63	2.1	
AUD	0.660	(0.3)		MXN	18.43	0.3		Gold (S)	3856.58	(0.2)	
CAD	1.397	0.2		BRL	5.34	0.2		WTI (Fut)	60.48	(2.1)	

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 4: G4 Central Bank Implied Pricing

Central Bank OIS															
Fed				ECB				BOE				BOJ			
Implied	1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ		Implied	1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ		Implied	1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ		Implied	1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ	
EFFR (10/1)	4.090	0.0	--	EOIA (10/1)	1.927	0.0	--	SONIA (10/1)	3.967	0.0	--	TONAR (10/1)	0.477	0.0	--
10/29/25	3.852	1.0	(23.8)	10/30/25	1.924	(0.1)	(0.3)	11/06/25	3.952	0.8	(1.5)	10/30/25	0.637	0.2	16.0
12/10/25	3.621	(0.1)	(46.9)	12/18/25	1.906	(0.1)	(2.1)	12/18/25	3.913	0.5	(5.4)	12/19/25	0.685	0.8	20.8
01/28/26	3.503	(0.5)	(58.7)	02/05/26	1.894	0.1	(3.3)	02/05/26	3.809	0.5	(15.9)	01/23/26	0.718	0.2	24.1
03/18/26	3.384	(0.2)	(70.6)	03/19/26	1.851	(0.4)	(7.6)	03/19/26	3.777	3.9	(19.0)				
04/29/26	3.318	(0.2)	(77.2)	04/30/26	1.844	(0.4)	(8.3)	04/30/26	3.691	1.5	(27.7)				
06/17/26	3.181	(0.7)	(90.9)	06/11/26	1.822	(1.2)	(10.5)	06/18/26	3.680	1.9	(28.8)				

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

The Day Ahead*Developed Markets*

- 10:05am JST - **BoJ Governor Ueda** will speak with business leaders in Osaka
- 8:45am BST - **France August Industrial Production** (MSe: 0.8%; C: 0.2%; P: -1.1%)
- 9:30am BST - **UK September Final PMI Services** (MSe: 51.9; C: 51.9; P: 51.9) & **PMI Composite** (MSe: 51.0; C: 51.0; P: 51.0). In line with flash estimate
- 2:20pm BST - **UK BOE Governor Bailey** will speak in Amsterdam
- 10:30am BST - **ECB Governing Council Member Sleijpen** will speak in Amsterdam
- 10:40am BST - **ECB President Lagarde** will speak in Amsterdam
- 11:30am BST - **ECB Governing Council Member Villeroy** will speak in Amsterdam
- 2:30pm BST - **ECB Executive Board Member Schnabel** will speak in Amsterdam
- 6:05am EST - **New York Fed President Williams** will speak in Amsterdam
- *Likely will not be released* - US September Unemployment Rate (MSe: 4.3%; C: 4.3%; P: 4.3%)
- 10:00am EST - **US September ISM Services Index** (C: 51.7; P: 52)
- 1:30pm EST - **Dallas Fed President Logan** will speak
- 1:40pm EST - **Fed Vice Chair Jefferson** will speak on the economic outlook

Emerging Markets

- 8:30am HKT - **Singapore S&P Global September PMI** (P: 51.2)
- 1:00pm HKT - **Singapore August Retail Sales** (C: 4.8% y/y; P: 4.8%)
- 8:00am BST - **Turkey September CPI** (MSe: 2.4% m/m; C: 2.58%; P: 2.04%). Our economists expect food and services inflation to push monthly inflation higher, while a modest TRY depreciation should contain core goods inflation.
- 8:00am EST - **Brazil August Industrial Production** (P: 0.2% y/y; C: -1.1%). Consensus expectations are weaker than the previous print, suggesting an

expectation of continued slowdown in industrial activity.

- 6:00pm EST - **Colombia Monetary Policy Minutes:** Markets will be watching for any shift in tone regarding inflation risks and the pace of future rate cuts, especially after the central bank's recent decision to hold rates steady.
- 8:00am EST - **Mexico July Gross Fixed Investment NSA:** (P: -6.4% y/y; C: -7.3%). Consensus expects Mexico's gross fixed investment to continue to contract, suggesting weak business confidence and soft momentum in capital spending.

Economic Releases

Developed Markets

- **US September Challenger Job Cuts:** -25.8% y/y (P: 13.3%). Low number of announced layoffs at 54k in September, down 25.8% y/y and down from an average of 63k per month last year (before the faster government layoffs). There were still some areas of strain: energy, construction, entertainment, and transport.
- **Euro Area August Unemployment Rate:** 6.3% (MSe: 6.2%; C: 6.2%; P: 6.2%)
- **Switzerland September CPI:** 0.2% y/y (C: 0.3%; P: 0.3%). Services was the primary driver for rising prices, not softness in goods.

Emerging Markets

- **Korea August Current Account Balance:** \$9.15bn (P: \$10.8bn)
- **Korea September Headline CPI:** 2.1% y/y (MSe: 1.9%; C: 2.0%; P: 1.7%) & **Core CPI:** 2.0% y/y (MSe: 1.9%; C: 2.0%; P: 1.3%)
- **Hong Kong August Retail Sales Volume:** 3.2% y/y (C: 1.9%; P: 0.9%) & **Value:** 3.8% y/y (C: 2.0%; P: 1.8%)

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G4 Smarter (Beta) Trading Partners

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Since 2000, enhancements to a G4 10y government bond futures momentum strategy have produced higher Sharpe ratios and stronger returns relative to total return government bond indices for the G4: US, Germany, Japan, and the UK. See [A "Smarter" \(Beta\) Way to Trade G4 10y Futures Duration?](#) for more information on these strategies.

Exhibit 5: Trading Signals for G4 Smarter (beta) Trading Strategy

Current Risk, G4 10y Futures	G4 Strategy Weight	Trade Longs Portfolio	Fade Shorts Portfolio	Total Risk Trade Longs Only	Total Risk Trade Longs/Fade Shorts (max 200%)	Trade Longs Portfolio Entry Date	Trade Longs Portfolio Exit Date	Fade Shorts Portfolio Entry Date	Fade Shorts Portfolio Exit Date
J8 10y Future	32.50%	100%	100%	100%	200%	9/9/2025	10/17/2025	9/19/2025	10/28/2025
GE 10y Future	29.25%	100%	100%	100%	200%	9/8/2025	10/14/2025	9/15/2025	10/20/2025
US 10y Future	30.50%	0%	100%	0%	100%	-	-	9/24/2025	10/30/2025
UK 10y Future	7.75%	100%	100%	100%	200%	9/10/2025	10/15/2025	9/25/2025	10/30/2025

Source: Morgan Stanley Research

Trading Strategy 1 – "Trade Longs/Fade Shorts"

When the 5-day moving average crosses above the 20-day moving average, buy the futures contract (long duration) and hold for a 25-business-day period. When the 5-day moving average crosses below the 20-day moving average, buy the futures contract and hold for a 25-business-day period. In short, this strategy buys futures when the Simple Moving Average Crossover (SMAX) generates both a long and a short signal, given the historical outperformance of long signals traded long and the underperformance of short signals traded short. Given that the SMAX could generate both a long and a short signal within the predefined holding period, an investor may have a 200% long position since each of the two signals would be traded in separate portfolio sleeves.

Trading Strategy 2 – Trade "Longs Only"

When the 5-day moving average crosses above the 20-day moving average, buy the futures contract (long duration) and hold for a 25-business-day period. When the 5-day moving average crosses below the 20-day moving average, do nothing. In short, an investor *only* trades long signals initiated by the SMAX given their historical precedent to outperform.

US Holiday Trading Strategy

Currently Active Strategies

None.

Combining the individual trading signals based on 10y Treasury future (TY) price patterns before and after US holidays has generated an annual strategy with no down years since 1987. See [Trading 10y Treasury Futures Around US Holidays](#) for more information.

Using historical data since 1983, we created a trading strategy using 10y Treasury futures (TY) that trades 11 times per year, either long or short, before or after the following US holidays: New Year's Day, Martin Luther King Day, Presidents' Day, Good Friday, Memorial Day, Independence Day, Labor Day, Columbus Day, Thanksgiving, and Christmas. [Exhibit 6](#) displays the trading rules:

Exhibit 6: Trading rules for US holiday trading model using US 10y futures contracts (TY)

Holiday	Day of Week	Direction	Before/After Holiday	Trading Rule (business days, 3pm NY unless specified)	Trade Entry (business days)	Trade Exit (business days)
New Year's Day	Rotates	Long TY	After	Buy TY New Years +1, Sell TY New Years +4	New Year + 1	New Year + 4
Martin Luther King Day 1	Monday	Long TY	Before	Buy TY Tuesday before MLK, Sell Friday before MLK	MLK - 4	MLK - 1
Martin Luther King Day 2	Monday	Short TY	After	Sell TY Tuesday after MLK, Buy Friday after MLK	MLK + 1	MLK + 4
President's Day	Monday	Long TY	After	Buy TY Tuesday after Pres. Day, Sell TY Friday after Pres. Day	Pres. Day + 1	Pres. Day + 4
Good Friday	Friday	Long TY	After	Buy TY Monday after Good Friday, Sell TY Friday after Good Friday	Good Friday + 1	Good Friday + 5
Memorial Day	Monday	Long TY	After	Buy TY Tuesday after Mem. Day, Sell TY Friday after Mem. Day	Mem. Day + 1	Mem. Day + 4
Independence Day (July 4th)	Rotates	Long TY	After	Buy TY Independence Day + 2, Sell TY Independence Day + 4	Ind. Day + 2	Ind. Day + 4
Labor Day	Monday	Long TY	Before	Buy TY Monday before Labor Day, Sell TY Thursday before Labor Day	Labor Day - 4	Labor Day - 2
Columbus Day	Monday	Short TY	Before	Sell TY Monday before Col. Day, Buy TY Thursday before Col. Day	Colum. Day - 5	Colum. Day - 2
Thanksgiving	Thursday	Long TY	Before	Buy TY Friday before Thanksgiving, Sell TY Tuesday before Thanksgiving	Thanksgiving - 4	Thanksgiving - 2
Christmas	Rotates	Short TY	Before	Sell TY Christmas Day - 4, Buy TY Christmas Day - 1	Christmas - 4	Christmas - 1

Source: Morgan Stanley Research. Note: Past performance is no guarantee of future results.

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(as of September 30, 2025)

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Stock Rating Category	Coverage Universe		Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1499	41%	389	46%	26%	702	41%
Equal-weight/Hold	1618	44%	375	44%	23%	782	45%
Not-Rated/Hold	4	0%	1	0%	25%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	577	16%	88	10%	15%	234	14%
Total	3,698		853			1719	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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